

Diversity

There are lots of different forms of diversity.

Different features define groups such as:

- race or other ethnic classifications
- age
- gender
- religion
- philosophy
- physical abilities
- socioeconomic background
- sexual orientation
- gender identity
- intelligence
- mental health
- physical health
- genetic attributes
- personality
- behavior or attractiveness.

In workplaces e.g., inclusion of individuals with these traits can be beneficial and it is being endorsed globally, to hire a diverse workforce.

The *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* affirms to „respect difference and acceptance of persons with disabilities as human diversity and humanity“for protection of human rights of persons with disabilities.

Diversity also plays a main factor in politics, as parties may identify themselves as accepting of different cultures or not. *Respect for Diversity* is one the principles of the *Global Greens Charter*, a manifesto subscribed to by Green Parties internationally.

Discrimination

Discrimination is the act of making unjustified distinctions based on the above-mentioned groups and every other non-defined group of people with unique features.

Historically, discrimination has been of great significance. Some examples would be Jim Crow Laws in the Southern United States, or the Nazi-fueled antisemitism.

Different countries provide various anti-discrimination laws, which may or may not be effective. New forms of harassment based on cultural differences can emerge by the means of migration, as it can be seen in countries, that accept lots of refugees.

Besides the individual countries, the UN has also defined anti-discrimination laws. Important UN documents include:

- The Universal Declaration of Human Rights 1948
- The International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination 1969
- The Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women 1969
- The Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities 1979

Minorities

Certain groups of people sharing a cultural, ethnical, religious, a racial distinction or their sexual orientation are being defined by other certain groups as minorities. The groups are being put into relation with a more dominant group, which makes minorities coexist as a subordinate group.

Discrimination against minorities occurs in multiple areas of social life, including housing, employment, healthcare, and education, among others. While discrimination may be committed by individuals, it may also occur through structural inequalities, in which rights and opportunities are not equally accessible to all.

In some cases, on or more minority groups may have a population many times the size of the dominating group, as was the case in South Africa under apartheid.

Many civil- or collective rights include minority groups. The language of minority right is often used to discuss laws designed to protect minority groups from discrimination and afford them equal social status to the dominant group.

In most societies men and women are not equal. Therefore, in those societies women can also be seen as minorities. They are often denied access to education, subject to violence, and lack access to the same economic opportunities as men.

In the politics of some countries, a minority is an ethnic group recognized by law, and having specified rights. Countries with special provisions for minorities include Canada, China, Ethiopia, Germany, India, the Netherlands, Poland, Romania, Russia, Croatia, and the United Kingdom.

Other countries, such as the United States ask for race and ethnicity on its official census forms, which thus breaks up and organizes its population into sub-groups, primary racial rather than national. Spain does not divide its nationals by ethnic group, although it does maintain an official notion of minority languages.